

Insurance Parity Laws and Reducing Suicides: Replicating Lang (2013)

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Abstract

Over the past two decades, despite efforts from psychologists and mental health professionals alike, the United States has seen a steady growth of suicides despite nearly all other Western countries experiencing the contrary. A part of this growth can be attributed to the lagging implementation of mental healthcare parity. The Mental Health Parity Act of 1996 (MHPA) due to its ineffectiveness at restricting insurance companies discrimination between treating bodily and mental injury. In this study, I attempt to replicate and build upon results from Lang (2013) using propensity score matching methods along with heterogenous difference-in-differences.

Introduction

In 2023, it had been estimated that at least 58.7 million adults in the United States had been diagnosed with some sort of mental illness SAMSHA et al. (2023). In the same year, 14.6 million adults were estimated to have a mental illness that resulted in acute functional impairment or interfered with at least one or more major daily life activities SAMSHA et al. (2023). Of those 14.6 million adults, only 66.7% received any mental health treatment in the past year SAMSHA et al. (2023). According to the Centers for Disease Control's (CDC) WISQARS Leading Causes of Death Report, suicides are the second leading cause of death amongst people aged 10-34 and are ranked as the 11th overall leading cause of death. Within two decades, suicide rates have gradually increased from 10.5 suicides per 100,000 people in the year 2000 to 14.2 per 100,000 in 2018 CDC et al. (2023). Suicide rates vary from state to state, with both East and West Coast supporting low rates such as 7.4 per 100,000 people while mid-western states suffer from rates as high as 25 per 100,000 people CDC et al. (2023). Modern economists use two-way fixed effects to control for these differences between states. Recently in the econometrics literature, more attention has been given to the problem of dynamic timing of federal policies and the potential bias it might bring to traditional two-way fixed effects. This study attempts to replicate Lang (2013) findings of the effects of the Mental Health Parity Act of 1996 using Sun & Abraham (2021), Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021), and Goodman-Bacon (2021) as a way to estimate the average treatment effect while deconstructing the two-way fixed effect regression. Additionally, several propensity score methods are used to compare with replicated and new results. My research finds that traditional methods are in line with previous results while dynamic timing methods estimate somewhere at 3% to 5% depending on the method and base period used. (Klick & Markowitz, 2006 ; CDC et al., 2023)

Lang (2013)

Lang (2013) attempts to identify causal effects using difference-in-difference methods and fixed effects using policy shocks which were the result from the after-effects of the Mental Health Parity Act of 1996 (MHPA). Lang (2013) showed a statistically significant effect of a 4-7% decrease in suicide rate after policy implementation using two-way fixed effects. To do this with the rollout of policies from the states, Lang (2013) set 1998 as t_0 since most of the state-level policies were enacted afterward. This paper draws from the same data detailed in the study while using modern difference-in-differences methods. The first the difference-in-difference regression replicates Lang (2013) while extending to propensity score matching methods to achieve a better balance between covariates between control and treatment states. Dynamic difference-in-differences methods are used for the data and found similar results as the preliminary difference-in-differences and Two-way Fixed Effects model.

Mental Health Parity Act

In 1996, Congress pushed forward the MHPA to address rising concerns about mental health and how insurers treat those with mental health disorders. The MHPA aimed to provide equal treatment of regular physical and psychological services. With the MHPA, Congress banned group insurance plans that have a lower annual lifetime dollar cap for mental health services compared to regular services; however, there were no stipulations if insurance providers did not offer mental health services. Subsequent reports from the General Accounting Office (GAO) concerning the MHPA put into question whether or not the federal law had any effect. Office (2000) While insurance companies were complying with the letter of the law, the law itself was only specific enough to require lifetime total costs between physical and mental treatment to be equal and did not prohibit other ways to limit utilization to insurance customers who had coverage through their insurance. For example, according to the GAO survey conducted after the MHPA was passed, employers bought

group insurance plans that restricted the amount of in-hospital mental health-related stays. Following the aftermath of the MHPA, most states by 2002 enacted either their own more restrictive parity laws or accepted the federal law as is. (Office, 2000; SAMSHA et al., 2023)

Parity laws:

Lang (2013) introduced 4 categories that parity laws fall into, 2 of which are considered parity laws and the rest are parity related laws that are ineffective or not at parity. States that have implemented laws that require insurance companies to provide packages that include access to mental health services, as well as require that these services are equal to those that are provided for physical wellness, are considered to be treated by parity law. Parity law states have two types of parity law, one where the state forces the provider to include mental health coverage and the other must be compelled to offer the insurance buyer mental health care. The former is referred to just as a ‘parity law’ while the latter is referred to as a ‘mandated offering law’. The non-parity laws are statutes that consist of either a ‘mandated minimum benefit law’ where some sort of mental care must be included or a ‘mandated if offered law’ where the mental health care is at parity *only* if the insurer provides it.

Data

The data set is constructed from multiple sources obtained through Lang (2013). The data set is a sample of 15 years from 1990 to 2004 in 50 states including the District of Columbia. The matrix is a total of 765 observations. There are 6 main variables, the first of which is the main outcome variable logged crude suicide rate. I pull from the CDC WONDER database CDC et al. (2023) for the compressed mortality statistics. Both queries included anything that was labeled under intentional self-harm fatalities in both ICD-9 and ICD-10. The same database also contained crude population statistics for each state in that given year. The Unemployment rate was obtained through The Current Population Survey. Bankruptcy

statistics were obtained through the US bankruptcy court tables converted into Excel data and coded from the available population statistics. The percent of workers from large firms variable was created from the County Business Patterns Survey obtained through the US Census website.

Further variables were hand-coded for the analysis. Information regarding the policy status of states during which years was taken from the appendix of Lang (2013). Binary variables were created that denoted the status of a parity or non-parity law in place, including the type of parity law enacted. Lastly, I created a variable that denoted the exact year where a parity law was enacted for each state which serves as a grouping variable for the Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021) analysis.

Summary Statistics

Table 1 details the weighted averages for the data set. The crude rate of suicides per 100k of the population was 11.32. The weighted mean log suicide rate was 2.4. The mean unemployment rate was 5.6. Mean bankruptcies per 100k is 436. The mean percent of workers in large firms in the data is 48%.

Table 2 subsets the data into 3 categories, Pre-Parity, Post-Parity, and No-Parity group. In the pre-parity group, the suicide rate was 10.85 while the post-parity suicide rate decreased to 9.84. The No-Parity Group had a weighted average of 12.57 throughout the data set’s time period.

Lang (2013) Simple Difference in Differences

Table 3 replicates the summary statistics found in Lang (2013) and uses the Lang (2013) method of implementing the difference in difference intervention in the year 1998. Here the weighted mean suicide rates of the pre and post-treatment group are 11.08 and 9.8

respectively. The pre and post-control group weighted mean stands at 12.89 and 12.43. Table 4 displays the weighted mean log suicide rates in a similar fashion.

Table 5 Introduces the simple difference-in-differences design that is explored in Lang (2013). Both panels are averages weighted by state populations that denote pre and post-group cutoff between the two periods of 1990-1997 and 1998-2004. Standard errors are reported in parenthesis and in brackets are the number of observations that fall in this group. Lang (2013) uses this specification to analyze the rest of his regressions. The main difference-in-difference results is replicated in both panels with a slightly higher Panel A result at 6.5% decrease in suicides. Panel B results at a similar 8%. Both are significant at the same levels in Lang (2013) Table 3.

My Difference in Difference

For the rest of this analysis, this paper will not be using the intervention timing assumption cut-off to conduct the rest of the regressions. All groups in the regressions after this point are accurate to the year they were implemented. That is to say, while Lang (2013) had to handle treated states as if they were passed in 1998 for the difference-in-difference framework to function, this analysis is afforded the liberty of using the dynamic difference-in-difference. Additionally, the analysis has excluded things present in Lang (2013) due to the author stating they had no impact on the main results. These include a lagged suicide rate timing control and dropping observations of states that passed a parity law in the middle of the year. Table 4 Column 2 also dropped observations so that only states that eventually become treated are left. I replicated this column with the data included and found no difference in the investigated effect.

Replicating Lang 2013

$$Suicide_{st} = \alpha + \beta_1 Access_{st} + \beta_2 NonParityLaw_{st} + \delta X_{st} + \gamma_s + \pi_t + \varepsilon_{st} \quad (1)$$

I used the typical panel approach in all the subsequent analyses unless stated otherwise. My dependent variable is denoted by $Suicide_{st}$ which is the log crude suicide rate per 100,000 people in the state s and year t . The $Access_{st}$ term denotes an Access to Parity Law in effect over the state s and time period t . $NonParityLaw_{st}$ term denotes a non-parity law, either a is in effect at state s and year t . X_{st} denotes unemployment, bankruptcy, and large firm controls. The γ_s and π_t are the state and yearly fixed effects respectively.

TWFE, MATCHING and Heterogeneous Treatment Effects

TWFE

Table 6 details a replication of Table 4 of Lang (2013). Regressing the log suicide rate, the first column returns a similar estimate to the first column of Table 4 in Lang (2013). Results present a 4.2% decrease in the suicide rate compared to Lang (2013) 5% for Access to Parity states. The second column replicates the same column in Lang (2013) finding another 4% reduction. This paper chose not to reduce our sample size for this column since both regressions report the same coefficient. Column (3) distinguishes itself from the rest of the regressions as the only model that loses the significance of the main variable and does not replicate from Lang (2013). Column (3) of Table 6 also shows Mandated offering laws significant for a 9% decrease in the log suicide rate compared to Lang (2013) 12%. Column (4) continues with the Access to Parity variable significant at the 5% level with a coefficient of 4.6% compared with Lang (2013) 7%. Overall, I see a similar or reduced magnitude in the estimated effect.

Matching

My first extension to Lang (2013) uses the assumption of a 1998 treatment time from @lang2013 and adds matching to the difference-in-differences model as a robustness check. I run several different matching methods available to the Ho et al. (2011) package.

Tables 7, 8, and 9 detail Difference-in-Differences regressions using two-way fixed effects. The same as previous models, variables are weighted by population at that specific state's point in time and additionally are clustered at the state level. Columns (1) and (2) detail the Difference in Difference models using Mahalanobis distance, switching between the regular and logged suicide rate. Columns (3) and (4) show models matched with a probit method. The only significant effect was found in column 4 with a -4% decrease associated with the post-treatment effect. Table 8 features GLM in columns (1) and (2) with the only significant effect belonging to column (2), finding the same coefficient as Table 7 Column (4). Columns (3) and (4) showcase models with Cardinality matching and find no significant effects. Table 9 Uses Coarse-Exact matching and Subclass matching to find the same coefficient in Column (4.) Overall every matching method that cut down on the observations or didn't use a logged crude rate did not retrieve significant effects.

Dynamic treatment Effects

The second extension to Lang (2013) is a dive into dynamic treatment effects using both Sun & Abraham (2021) and Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021) to see if a roll-out design can capture the same effects found in the previous regressions. Here is an evaluation of the effect on each state's access to parity policy without worrying about introducing contamination through comparisons of past and future treated units. I will first introduce the Sun & Abraham (2021) results, compare them with Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021) results, and then complete the discussion with the Goodman-Bacon (2021) decomposition.

Interaction-weighted estimates (Sun and Abraham 2021) Table 10 displays the results of 3 models run with varying base periods. All regressions use the parity law group variable that tracks the first year of each policy implementation. The first model with a base period of -1 does not return a significant ATT when evaluating parity law policy. The second column does return a significant effect of a 3% decrease in suicides with a base period of -2.

The third column follows a suggestion of dropping the first year of the data set from Sun & Abraham (2021) to add more control units, resulting in a similar 3% decrease in suicides.

Difference in Difference with Multiple Time Periods (Callaway and Sant’Anna)

Table 11 contains the estimates for Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021). All regressions use the parity law group timing discussed in the last section. Columns (1), (2), and (3) arrive at similar estimates of a 5% decrease in suicides, the first two using the universal base period while Column (3) uses a varying base period. In Column (4), I experimented with setting different anticipation periods and saw results at a significant 3% decrease in suicides with the anticipation setting at -1.

Event Studies

Figure 1 and Figure 3 show the event studies from Sun & Abraham (2021) and Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021) results respectively. The Sun & Abraham (2021) graph is overlaid with the three regressions from Table 10. The Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021) event study is graphed from the first column regression in Table 11. Both event study tables show similarly significant results for at least 2 years after policy implementation.

In the Sun & Abraham (2021) event study, we can see pre-trends are apparent in the regressions. In Figure 1, some states experienced an significant effect of an increase in suicides 7 years before they were treated. When the event study moves the base period to 2 years before treatment, this effect is magnified and spreads to units that were treated 8 and 9 years in the future. This is evidence for a violation in the parallel trends assumptions and the Sun & Abraham (2021) regressions are not sound for conclusions. However, it's seen in Figure 3 that the Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021) does not suffer from the same parallel trends violation and maintains significance two years after policy implementation.

Goodman-Bacon

Figure 2 shows the results of the Goodman-Bacon (2021) decomposition graph breakdown of the weights involved in a Two-way Fixed Effects Regression on the log suicide rate without population weighting. From the graph, we can show that the treated vs untreated comparisons make up most of the weight on the ATT, only 30% of comparisons made consist of those “forbidden” comparisons of early vs later treated that can introduce contaminated results. So while the initial analysis in Lang (2013) did primarily use the correct comparisons in their difference in difference, Figure 2 shows that by using dynamic difference in differences there is a tangible weighting bias reduction compared to previous estimates.

Conclusion

My findings concur with the of the seminal paper Lang (2013) and estimate a negative 3-5% effect on suicides. Borrowing from Lang (2013) back of the hand math, 29 states had a suicide rate of 10.24 and a total population of 160,221,455. A decrease of 3% to 5% would save between 492 to 820 lives nationally per year. Although the decrease in suicides could be attributed to the Mental Health Parity Act of 1996, it would be more apt to recognize it as a catalyst of change. The true mechanism behind these results were the laws that followed which enforced stricter guidelines for insurance firms. As explained in Harrison (2002), the enacting of the MHPA created incentives for states to pass their version of parity law to circumvent federal oversight. Due to a provision in the law that dictates as long as a state fulfills the minimum requirements, it can retain the authority to regulate parity laws. This resulted in the wave of states implementing parity laws afterward.

One of the main limitations of this study revolves around the 1 in 10 rule for judging how many controls a model can handle before the model is in danger of overfitting. In the case of the regular two-way fixed effects, we have 3 main controls while we have 66 total state and year controls with a n of 765 resulting in a rough ratio of 11 observations per control.

Best practices taken from Harrell et al. (1985) dictate that this ratio is at the line where we would begin considering data-reduction methods or LASSO methods. For the newer methods, we have a total of 112 controls, for a cohort of 8 treatment years multiplied by the 14 years taken into consideration, dropping the first year of each cohort. This results in a ratio of roughly 7 observations per control, firmly below the rule of thumb. A combination of some cohorts having less than 30 observations causes logistic regression used by Callaway & Sant’Anna (2021) and their doubly robust methods return blown-up standard errors and missing values.

Policy implications are straightforward. The data suggests stronger, more restrictive parity laws provide a pathway toward healthcare utilization that leads to suicide rate reduction. If full parity granted in 29 states resulted in a national 5% reduction in the suicide rate, it’s worth pursuing politically. Future research using quality microdata would be a powerful way of working with the question of the effectiveness of mental health parity laws. One such study already exists in Drake et al. (2019) which looks at healthcare utilization after the 2008 Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act. Additionally, papers like Ortega (2023) which study Medicaid expansion while using dynamic differences-in-differences, are a great framework as the study calls to account for policy rollout rather than single implementation. Further research should turn their attention to the new 2024 Federal Parity rules that the Biden administration has implemented to combat non-quantitative treatment limitations that insurers use to inhibit utilization. Studies should be done not only to investigate effects of parity law on health care utilization but also outcomes like substance abuse statistics, attempted and completed suicides. [Ortega (2023)](Harrell et al., 1985)

Figures

Table 1: Summary Statistics

Variable	N	Wt. Mean	Wt. SD	Min	Pctl. 25	Pctl. 75	Max
Suicide Rate	765	11.32	2.681	4.021	10.59	13.98	24.97
Log suicide rate	765	2.398	0.2415	1.392	2.36	2.638	3.218
Unemployment rate	765	5.573	1.421	2.108	4.267	6.192	11.23
Bankruptcy rate per 100k	765	435.6	169.5	79.46	287.6	516.5	1117
Percent of workers in large Firms	765	0.483	0.03803	0.2699	0.4291	0.5025	0.5711

Table 2: Summary Statistics

Pre_Post_Parity	No-Parity			Post-Parity			Pre-Parity		
Variable	N	Wt. Mean	Wt. SD	N	Wt. Mean	Wt. SD	N	Wt. Mean	Wt. SD
Suicide Rate	330	12.57	2.263	178	9.848	2.583	257	10.85	2.548
Log suicide rate	330	2.517	0.1696	178	2.255	0.2545	257	2.356	0.2385
Unemployment rate	330	5.338	1.288	178	5.134	1.113	257	6.131	1.568
Bankruptcy rate per 100k	330	442.5	188.5	178	476.1	169.3	257	401.3	137.3
Percent of workers in large Firms	330	0.4887	0.03845	178	0.4886	0.03846	257	0.4727	0.03511

Table 3: Weighted Mean Suicide Rates of Treated and Nontreated States, Pre and Post Period for (Lang2013) Difference in Difference

Time Period Group	mean	st.err	sd	n
NoTreatPost-Period	12.2426	0.2118	2.0905	154
NoTreatPre-Period	12.8921	0.2264	2.3786	176
Post-Period	9.7867	0.2927	2.5778	203
Pre-Period	11.0831	0.2616	2.4765	232

Table 4: Weighted Mean Log Suicide Rates of Treated and Nontreated States, Pre and Post Period (Lang2013) Difference in Difference

Time Period Group	mean	st.err	sd	n
NoTreatPost-Period	2.4915	0.0165	0.1625	154
NoTreatPre-Period	2.5413	0.0165	0.1732	176
Post-Period	2.2485	0.0288	0.2537	203
Pre-Period	2.3800	0.0241	0.2285	232

Table 5: Difference in Difference estimates of the impact of access to parity mandates on suicide rates:(Lang2013) Replication

Panel A			
State/ Type Period	1990-1997	1998-2004	difference between periods
Access to Parity States	11.083 (.262) [232]	9.787 (.293) [203]	-1.2964 (0.2272)
No Parity States/ No Law States	12.892 (0.226) [154]	12.2426 (0.212) [176]	0.6495 (0.2730)
Difference between types of states	-1.809 (0.2481)	-2.456 (0.2541)	
Difference in Difference		-.647* (0.3552)	
Panel B			
State/ Type Period	1990-1997	1998-2004	difference between periods
Access to Parity States	2.380 (.024) [232]	2.249 (.029) [203]	-.131 (.0202)
No Parity States/ No Law States	2.541 (.0165) [176]	2.492 (.0165) [154]	-.049 (.02422)
Difference between types of states	-.161 (.022)	-.243 (.0226)	
Difference in Difference		-.0817*** (.032)	

Each cell contains the average suicide rate/log suicide rate for the specified group that are weighted by yearly state population.

Standard errors are reported in parentheses; sample sizes are reported in brackets.

Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1

Table 6: The Two-way Fixed Effect Regressions on the Impact of Mental Health Parity Laws

Dependent Variable: Model:	Log Suicide Rate			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
<i>Variables</i>				
Access To Parity	-0.0418*** (0.0129)	-0.0411*** (0.0131)		-0.0461** (0.0186)
Non Parity Law	-0.0019 (0.0134)			
Unemployment Rate	0.0152*** (0.0049)	0.0152*** (0.0049)	0.0151*** (0.0049)	0.0155*** (0.0049)
Bankruptcy Per 100k	0.0002*** (4.38×10^{-5})	0.0002*** (4.41×10^{-5})	0.0003*** (4.26×10^{-5})	0.0002*** (4.29×10^{-5})
PercW	0.6413 (0.4625)	0.6406 (0.4636)	0.5383 (0.4542)	0.6499 (0.4739)
Parity Law Passed			-0.0319 (0.0199)	
Mandated offering laws			-0.0897*** (0.0241)	
Mandated if Offered			-0.0220 (0.0179)	-0.0220 (0.0179)
No Parity Law			-0.0035 (0.0146)	-0.0043 (0.0148)
<i>Fixed-effects</i>				
State	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year.x	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
<i>Fit statistics</i>				
Observations	765	765	765	765
R ²	0.94704	0.94704	0.94836	0.94715
Within R ²	0.21667	0.21664	0.23619	0.21825

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses
*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Table 7: Matched Table A

Dependent Variables: Matching Model:	Crude Suicide Rate Mahalanobis	Log Suicide Rate Mahalanobis	Crude Suicide Rate Full with Probit	Log Suicide Rate Full with Probit
<i>Variables</i>				
TreatPost	0.060 (0.329)	-0.015 (0.028)	-0.279 (0.176)	-0.043*** (0.015)
‘unemploymentrate’	0.229* (0.126)	0.027** (0.011)	0.121** (0.057)	0.014*** (0.005)
Bankruptcy Per 100,000	0.0007 (0.0006)	5.64×10^{-5} (4.79×10^{-5})	0.003*** (0.0005)	0.0003*** (4.25×10^{-5})
Percent Working in Large Firms	6.05 (8.36)	0.539 (0.788)	-0.346 (4.43)	0.548 (0.435)
<i>Fixed-effects</i>				
State	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year.x	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
<i>Fit statistics</i>				
Observations	284	284	765	765
R ²	0.96644	0.96979	0.94241	0.94692
Within R ²	0.03924	0.06029	0.14513	0.21481

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses

*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Table 8: Matched Table B

Dependent Variables: Matching Model:	Crude Suicide Rate Full with GLM	Log Suicide Rate Full with GLM	Crude Suicide Rate Full with Cardinality	Log Suicide Rate Full with Cardinality
<i>Variables</i>				
TreatPost	-0.279 (0.176)	-0.043*** (0.015)	-0.103 (0.408)	-0.038 (0.038)
‘unemploymentrate’	0.121** (0.057)	0.014*** (0.005)	0.418*** (0.136)	0.039*** (0.013)
Bankruptcy Per 100,000	0.003*** (0.0005)	0.0003*** (4.25×10^{-5})	0.0002 (0.0009)	-1.08×10^{-5} (8.48×10^{-5})
Percent Working in Large Firms	-0.346 (4.43)	0.548 (0.435)	17.8** (8.07)	1.84** (0.803)
<i>Fixed-effects</i>				
State	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year.x	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
<i>Fit statistics</i>				
Observations	765	765	168	168
R ²	0.94241	0.94692	0.97177	0.97352
Within R ²	0.14513	0.21481	0.12200	0.16782

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses

*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Table 9: Matched Table C

Dependent Variables: Matching Model:	Crude Suicide Rate Coarse-Exact Matching	Log Suicide Rate Coarse-Exact Matching	Crude Suicide Rate Subclass	Log Suicide Rate Subclass
<i>Variables</i>				
TreatPost	-0.156 (0.217)	-0.027 (0.020)	-0.279 (0.176)	-0.043*** (0.015)
‘unemploymentrate’	0.108 (0.119)	0.018 (0.012)	0.121** (0.057)	0.014*** (0.005)
Bankruptcy Per 100,000	0.002** (0.0007)	0.0002** (7.95×10^{-5})	0.003*** (0.0005)	0.0003*** (4.25×10^{-5})
Percent Working in Large Firms	-6.37 (7.16)	-0.002 (0.666)	-0.346 (4.43)	0.548 (0.435)
<i>Fixed-effects</i>				
State	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year.x	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
<i>Fit statistics</i>				
Observations	319	319	765	765
R ²	0.96784	0.96903	0.94241	0.94692
Within R ²	0.07776	0.10345	0.14513	0.21481

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses

*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Table 10: Sun and Abraham Estimates

Dependent Variable: Model:	lcruderate		
	(Base Period: -1)	(Base Period: -2)	(BP:-2 First Year Dropped)
<i>Variables</i>			
Unemployment Rate	0.0148*** (0.0053)	0.0148*** (0.0053)	0.0152*** (0.0052)
Bankrupcy per 100k	0.0003*** (7.04×10^{-5})	0.0003*** (7.04×10^{-5})	0.0003*** (7.01×10^{-5})
Percent Working in Large Firms	0.1840 (0.2827)	0.1840 (0.2827)	0.2052 (0.2760)
ATT	-0.0214 (0.0153)	-0.0306** (0.0126)	-0.0317** (0.0126)
<i>Fixed-effects</i>			
State	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year.x	Yes	Yes	Yes
<i>Fit statistics</i>			
Observations	765	765	765
R ²	0.95810	0.95810	0.95798
Within R ²	0.38016	0.38016	0.37840

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses

*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Table 11: Calloway and Sant'Anna Estimates

Regression	No Covariates	Covariates	Varying Base Period	Anticipation Periods:-1
Weighted Average Group				
Estimate	-0.0520***	-0.0521***	-0.0521***	-0.0303*
Std.error	(0.0181)	(0.0185)	(0.0177)	(0.0132)
Group Average				
Estimate	-0.0532***	-0.0523***	-0.0523***	-0.0301*
Std.error	(0.0143)	(0.0143)	(0.0149)	(0.0087)

Clustered (State) standard-errors in parentheses

*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

Figure 1.

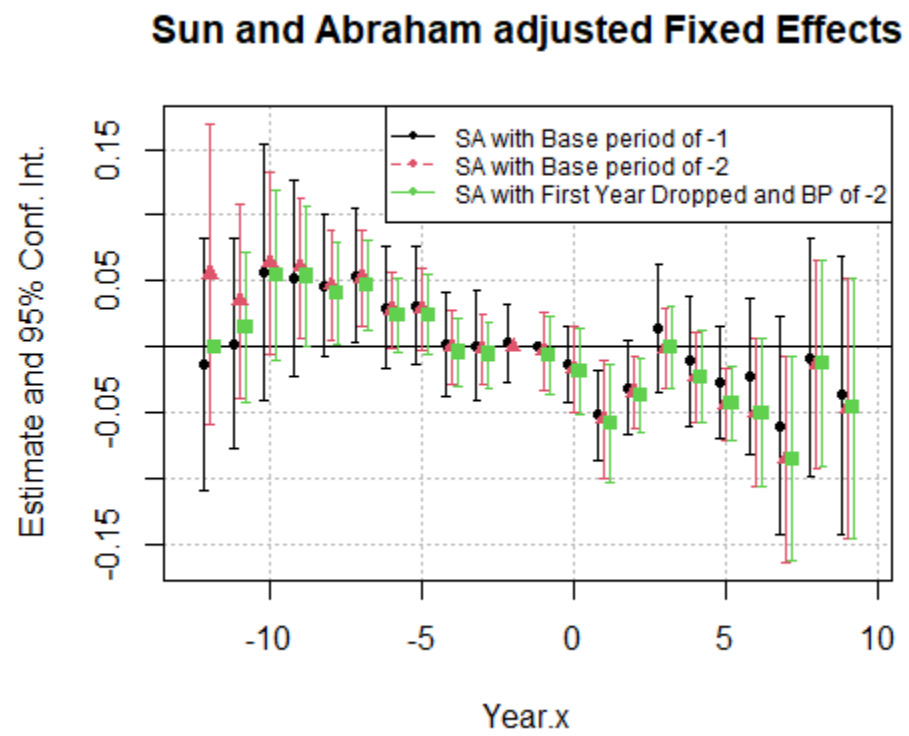


Figure 2.

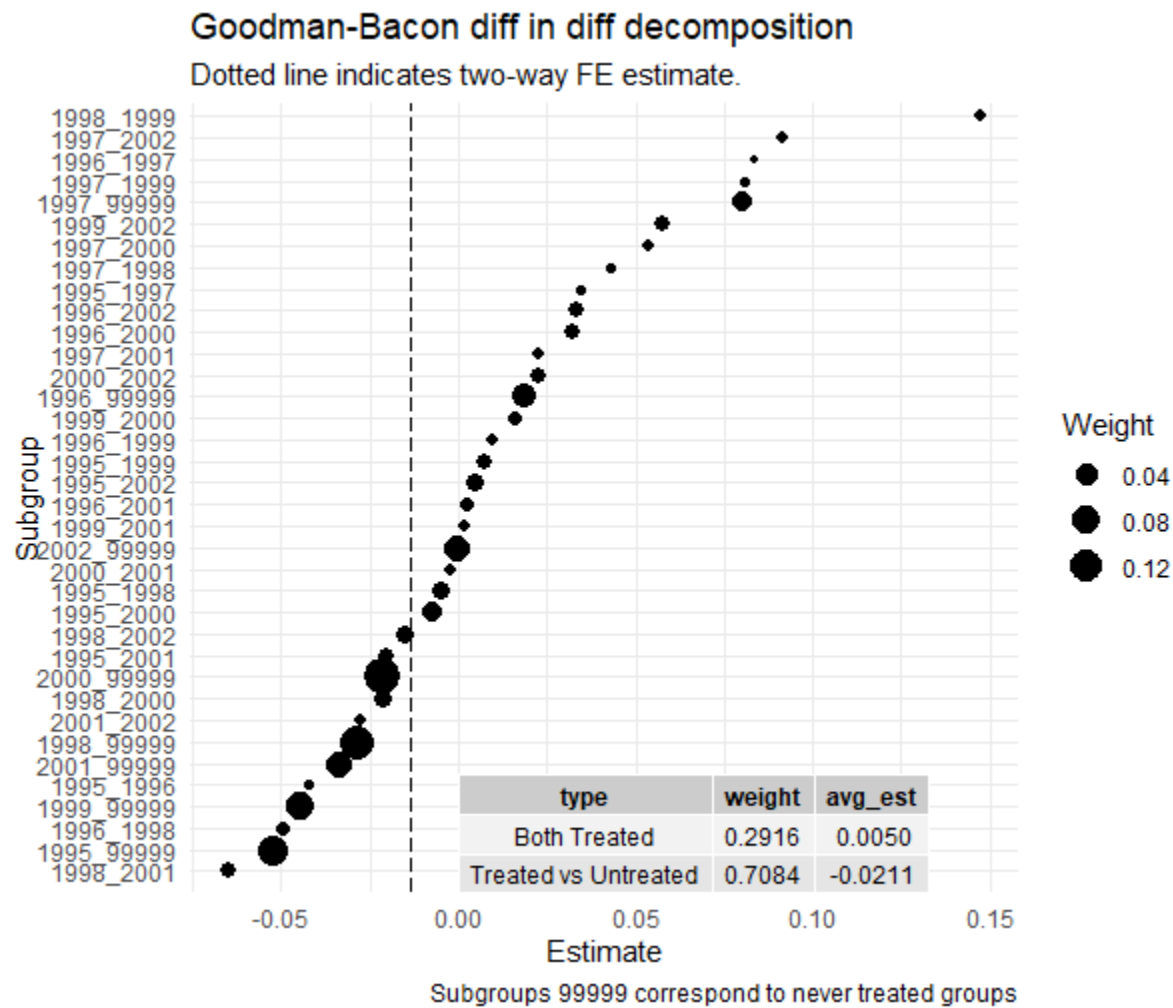


Figure 3.

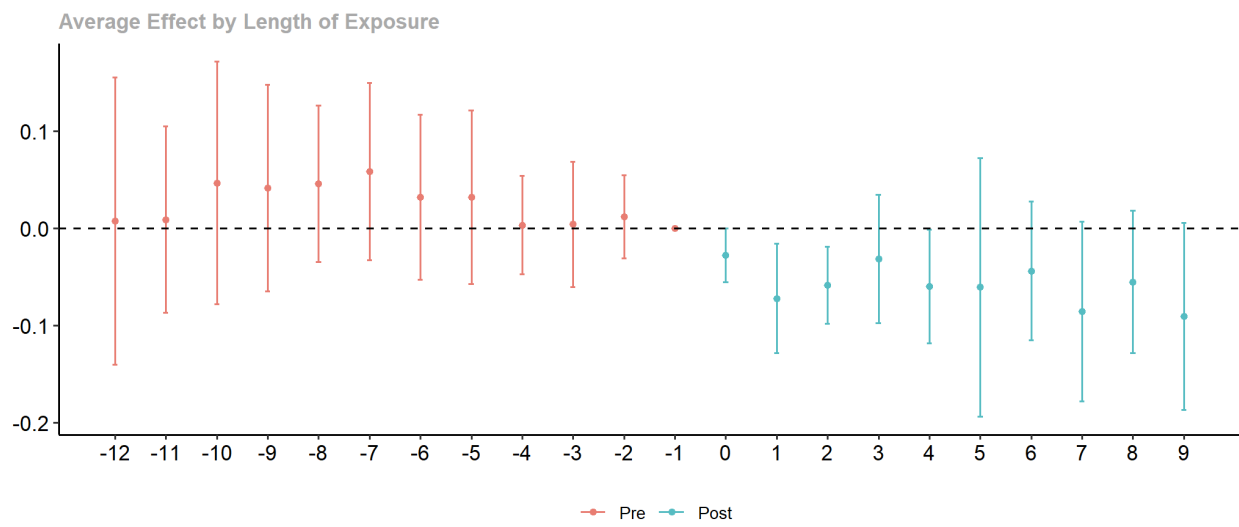
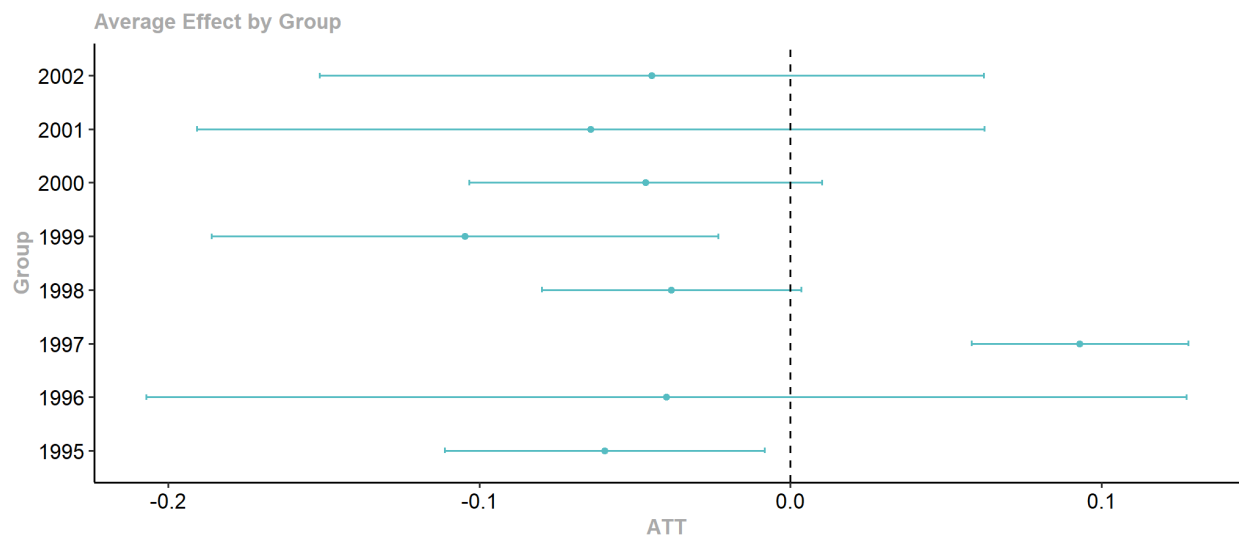


Figure 4.



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